mha
Live later life well

Our brand
2024

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Our logo

Usage

Our logo is the single most important element in our identity. Therefore all rules and regulations around it should be strictly adhered to.

The logo should always appear as it does in this guideline document. It must not be altered or redrawn in any way.

Do not use photocopies or web versions for print.

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Our logo

Variations

Our full colour logo should always be used wherever possible.

If this isn't suitable, a single-colour 'reversed out' version may be used.

Acceptable single colour reproduction includes white on an accessible solid background brand colour, like MHA pink or MHA teal. Or MHA pink on a white background.

Please **do not** overlay our logo on photographic backgrounds.

Typography

Arial is our brand font, and is used across all of our print and digital communications.

The Arial family features Regular and Bold weights.

Our accent font is Caveat, and we use a combination of Regular and Bold weights.

Caveat can be downloaded for free from Google Fonts.

Accessibility note

Body copy should be no smaller than 12pt where possible.

Body copy

Arial **Arial Bold**

Headlines / accent

Caveat Caveat bold

Colours

Primary palette

MHA Pink
C12 M100 Y0 K0
Pantone 233
R212 G0 B127
HEX #d4007f

MHA Blue
C78 M20 Y0 K42
Pantone 2391
R33 G117 B147
HEX #217593

MHA Teal
C58 M0 Y31 K0
Pantone 563
R107 G187 B174
HEX #6bbbae

Colours

Secondary palette

The secondary palette is designed to complement the primary colours, and provide variation and diversity where needed (such as graphs and diagrams, infographics and illustrations).

Light green
C47 M0 Y72 K0
Pantone 367
R155 G199 B105
HEX #9bc769

Orange
C0 M58 Y94 K0
Pantone 151
R255 G130 B0
HEX #ff8200

Yellow
C0 M30 Y87 K0
Pantone1235
R251 G187 B45
HEX #fbbb2d

Mid purple
C60 M66 Y0 K0
Pantone 272
R126 G100 B169
HEX #7e64a9

Light blue
C72 M0 Y10 K0
Pantone 3545
R70 G191 B224
HEX #46bfe0

Charcoal
C69 M60 Y56 K66
Pantone Black 2
R51 G51 B51
HEX #333333

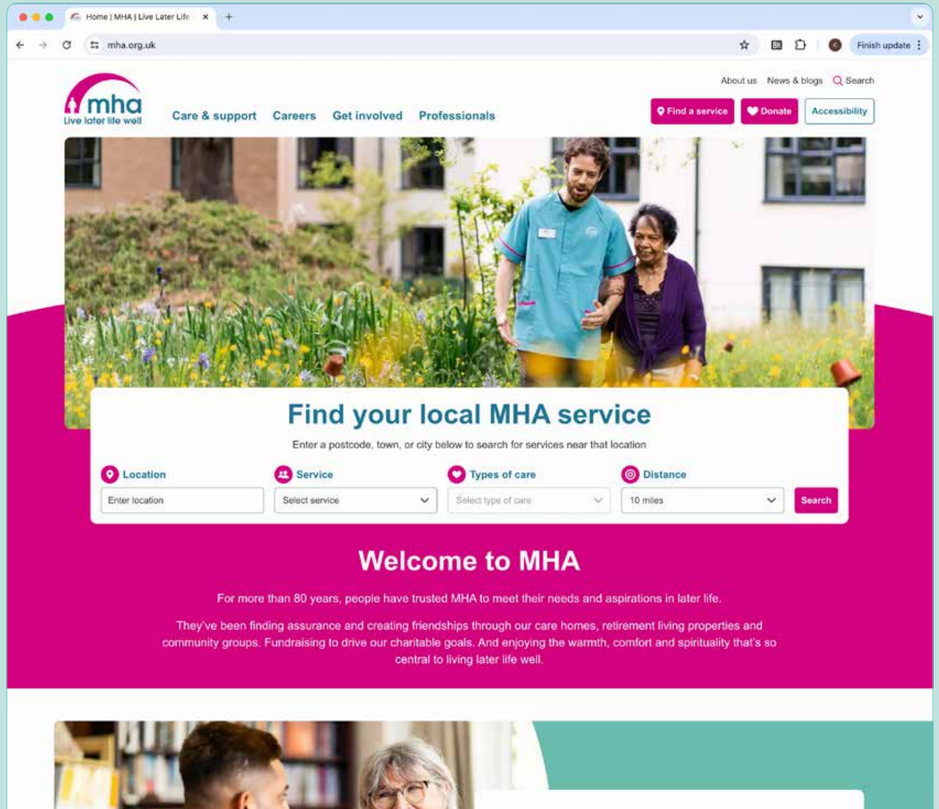
Colours

Accessibility

This shows how the brand colours can be used with text for WCAG 2.2 AA guidelines level of accessibility.

The colour of the ‘Aa’ indicated the correct colour usage for high level contrast to the above guidelines.

Aa	Aa	Aa	Aa
Aa	Aa	Aa	Aa
Aa	Aa	Aa	Aa



Our brand voice

Considerations

Our tone of voice needs to touch everything we do – every leaflet, advert or webpage. Every social strategy. Every conversation.

The MHA brand voice seeks to make a connection with all of our audiences – acknowledging the nuances, and building relatable, understanding narratives that our audiences can trust.

When writing for our audiences, no matter the medium, we must remember to:

- **Always write using 'human' language**
  Common terminology like 'person-centred' or 'respite' or 'convalescent' – while being sector relevant – sound cold and unrelatable to those searching for solutions. By softening our language, for example by substituting the word 'respite' for 'short stay' ensures we can deliver our messages in a friendly, relatable way.
- **Align our messaging with support, not care, and reflect the brand mantra - live later life well**
  We must always convey the feeling of independence and choice, and the emphasis on community and activities, as those are values intrinsic to living later life well.
- **Uphold our brand foundations**
  Charity and faith are at the very heart of our brand foundations, so they must always be appropriately and sensitively reflected across our brand messaging – see example on page 16.

Humanising our approach

As well as adjusting our language to be more human, we need to place a more considered focus on the audience.

We should talk to them, and not about them.

So instead of shouting about MHA's descriptive attributes – i.e. 'What makes Willowcroft so special' – we could re-frame it as 'Our commitment to you'.

Care home bullets (existing)

What makes Willowcroft so special?

- Personalised care plans, developed with residents and their family
- Caring, professional colleagues
- Music therapy for residents living with dementia
- Dedicated chaplain for pastoral care
- Landscaped secure gardens
- In-house hair salon
- Lots of activities

Care home bullets (refreshed)

Our commitments to you:

- You'll remain in control of your care and support. Always.
- You'll be supported by a caring, compassionate team.
- You'll benefit from proven and pioneering therapies.
- You'll be welcomed into a diverse diary of activities.
- You'll be valued and respected in a like-minded community.
- You'll be free to make this home your own – inside and out.

Our brand voice

Examples

Here are some examples of how we are shifting our brand tone of voice to elevate our proposition and forge audience connections.

General boilerplate (existing)

We're proud to be the UK's largest charity care provider and are dedicated to enabling older people to live later life well.

Through specialist care homes, thriving retirement living and vibrant community groups and befriending, we inspire the best care and wellbeing at every stage of later life.

With 80 years experience, we put people at the heart of everything we do in all our homes, schemes and community services across Britain.

General boilerplate (refreshed)

For more than 80 years, families have been choosing MHA to support the needs and aspirations of their loved ones in later life.

People have been forging friendships through our community programmes. Fundraising to drive our charitable goals. And spreading the warmth, comfort and spirituality that you'll find across every MHA home, community and development.

It's always for one reason, which will always stay the same: **Helping older people to live later life well.**

Examples

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Dementia positioning (existing)

At MHA, we take pride in being at the forefront of person-centred dementia care in the UK.

Our dedicated dementia care homes are specifically designed to provide specialised support for individuals living with dementia. We deeply understand the unique needs of each resident and strive to help them live their later life to the fullest with compassion and expertise.

We have earned a well-deserved reputation for delivering some of the highest quality care in the industry. Our person-centred approach means that we see each person as a remarkable individual and cater to their spiritual and physical needs with genuine care and support.

Dementia positioning (refreshed)

It can be hard to imagine that life with dementia can continue to be a life well-lived; one that's comfortable, enriching and loving.

But with specialist support, in the right surroundings, dementia should never take away a person's individuality, their dignity, or their ability to connect with the people they love the most.

We hope there's reassurance in knowing the professional dementia care you'll find at MHA is amongst the best in the country. It's made possible by highly trained, devoted teams. By pioneering techniques and technology. And it's all underpinned by our charitable ethos, and the spirituality and warmth that flows through every MHA home, community and development.

Our brand voice

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Respite care positioning (existing)

What is respite care?

Respite care, also known as short-term or short-stay care, is a temporary living arrangement for residents within one of our care homes across England, Scotland and Wales. It gives both carers, and those being cared for, a bit of time off and a chance to recharge their batteries.

Everyone staying with us for a respite break will receive personalised care, tailored to their individual needs.

They'll have their own furnished room, be welcomed into the home and encouraged to take part in the life of the home and the many activities on offer.

Respite care positioning (refreshed)

Short care breaks

Everyone needs a break from time to time. And although we understand you might feel worried or guilty about trusting MHA with the short-term care of your loved one, we also know the power of short care breaks in restoring the energy of family carers, whilst rejuvenating the relationship with their loved one.

Visit your local MHA home, and you'll quickly see why people thrive in their short breaks with us. You'll appreciate that you'll always be in control of support decisions. You'll see our immaculate homes are made to enhance comfort and independence.

And you'll feel the friendship, spirituality and warmth that's defined MHA for more than 80 years.

Examples

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Retirement living positioning (refreshed)

Welcome to MHA's The Maples – retirement living in Peterborough.

You'll find The Maples retirement living community on Goldhay Way in Peterborough. Join us for a visit, and you'll quickly discover that this is a place for people that value their independence. That crave a sense of community. And gain confidence in knowing that support is on-hand, should it ever be needed.

With our quiet location, generous gardens and wooded backdrop, you might be surprised to discover that our peaceful positioning is a matter of minutes from a wealth of local amenities, including Peterborough's Ortongate Shopping Centre.

But you won't be surprised to hear that wellbeing is at the heart of everything we do. That support is tailored to the precise needs of each person. And that it's all underpinned by our charitable ethos, along with the spirituality and warmth that flows through every MHA home, community and development.

Our brand voice

Examples

Here are some examples of how we are shifting our brand tone of voice to elevate our proposition and forge audience connections.

Care home – non-faith emphasis (refreshed)

Choosing a care home can be a difficult journey for any family. But your local team at Willowcroft care home in Derby will be here to guide you every step of the way.

You'll find us conveniently located in Spondon – easily accessible from the A52, and just a short distance from the beautiful river Derwent.

Join us for a visit and you'll quickly see why people say we feel like a second family. You'll understand that our care team simply won't compromise in the quality of their support. You'll see our immaculate home is made to enhance the comfort and independence of older people.

And we hope you'll see how the support and surroundings of Willowcroft care home could welcome a new lease of life for the person you love – with wellbeing, respect and friendship at its heart.

Care home – faith emphasis (refreshed)

Choosing a care home can be a difficult journey for any family. But your local team at Willowcroft care home in Derby will be here to guide you every step of the way.

You'll find us conveniently located in Spondon – easily accessible from the A52, and just a short distance from the beautiful river Derwent.

Join us for a visit and you'll quickly see why people say we feel like a second family. You'll understand that our care team simply won't compromise in the quality of their support. You'll see our immaculate home is made to enhance the comfort and independence of older people. And you'll be welcome to spend time with our chaplain, the spiritual anchor for so many people living with Willowcroft.

We hope you'll see how the support and surroundings of Willowcroft care home could welcome a new lease of life for the person you love – with wellbeing, respect and friendship at its heart.

Examples

Here are some examples of how we are shifting our brand tone of voice to elevate our proposition and forge audience connections.

Recruitment (existing)

Work with us

Discover a career that combines passion and purpose. Be part of an organisation that celebrates diversity and stands at the forefront of care and compassion. Whatever your role with MHA, it's more than just a job.

Recruitment (refreshed)

Your future with MHA

You want to make a difference in your career. And you're looking for an employer that's different too. At MHA, we're defined by our long-standing, like-minded teams: X people working together to help others **live later life well.**

So whether you join one of our care homes, retirement living developments, community programmes, or office roles, you'll be joining a team that's fused by the spirit of togetherness. That's inspired by innovation. Passionate about progress. With ambition and compassion at the heart of everything we do.

Our brand voice

House style

For consistency, we should follow a house style for common copy concerns – such as times and dates.

Times

Always use a 12-hour clock.

Always show am or pm

For an hour on the nose, we write **8am** or **3pm**

For anything that is past an hour, we use a colon to separate the hours from the minutes – for example, **3:45pm**.

Dates

The grammatically correct way to display dates in writing is to omit the ‘th’ and ‘st’ that we would naturally speak.

Instead, we would stylise a date as **2 September**, always stating the day before the month, and always writing the month in full.

Typically we’d avoid using the year, unless the date refers to a past time, or an upcoming date not within the current year.

Should you need any more guidance,
please contact the MHA marketing team.

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